

OCR GCSE IN PSYCHOLOGY

1989

Key Features

- A clear progression route to the revised OCR AS/A Level Psychology specifications.
- Candidate-friendly teaching through applied psychology.
- Revised supporting text.
- Wide choice of coursework tasks.
- Coursework can be linked to Key Skills.
- Submitted to the British Psychological Society for approval.

Support and In-Service Training for Teachers

- A full programme of In-Service training meetings arranged by the Training and Customer Support Division (telephone 01223 552950).
- Specimen question papers and mark schemes, available from the Publications Department (telephone 0870 870 6622; fax 0870 870 6621).
- Past question papers and mark schemes, available from the Publications Department (telephone 0870 870 6622; fax 0870 870 6621).
- Coursework guidance materials.
- Examples of marked coursework.
- Written advice on coursework proposals.
- A report on the examination, compiled by senior examining personnel after each examination session.
- Individual feedback to each Centre on the moderation of internally assessed work.
- A website: (www.ocr.org.uk).
- A Teachers' Handbook.
- A Students' Guide.

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Throughout the specification the following icons are used to signpost teaching and learning opportunities in:

 Citizenship

 ICT

 Key Skills

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SECTION A: SPECIFICATION SUMMARY

TIERS

The scheme of assessment consists of two tiers: Foundation Tier and Higher Tier. Foundation Tier assesses grades G to C and Higher Tier assesses grades D to A*. Candidates will be entered for either the Foundation Tier or the Higher Tier.

Grades	Foundation Tier G to C	Higher Tier D to A*
A*	Candidates take components 1, 2 and 5	Candidates take components 3, 4 and 5
A		
B		
C		
D		
E		
F		
G		

COMPONENTS

There are five components in total. Four are question papers and one is a task which is internally assessed and externally moderated.

Component	Title	Duration	Weighting
1	Paper 1	1 hour 15 mins	40%
2	Paper 2	1 hour 15 mins	40%
3	Paper 3	1 hour 15 mins	40%
4	Paper 4	1 hour 15 mins	40%
5	Coursework	-	20%
85	<i>Coursework Carried Forward</i>	-	20%

QUESTION PAPERS

Candidates sit two equally weighted question papers, each of 1 hour 15 minutes duration; together they carry 80% of the final mark allocation.

ENTRY OPTIONS

All candidates should be entered for 1989 with one of the following option codes:

Option Code	Title	Components
F	Foundation Tier	1, 2 and 5
H	Higher Tier	3, 4 and 5
FC	Foundation Tier - <i>Coursework Carried Forward</i>	1, 2 and 85
HC	Higher Tier- <i>Coursework Carried Forward</i>	3, 4 and 85

Options FC and HC are available for candidates re-sitting the qualification who wish to carry forward their coursework. This may be done once only and within a year of original entry.

INTERNAL ASSESSMENT

Candidates are required to complete one task which is internally assessed and externally moderated. It carries 20% of the final mark allocation.

SECTION B: GENERAL INFORMATION

1 Introduction

1.1 RATIONALE

This specification has been designed to enable candidates to have the opportunity to study psychology at an introductory level, yet also to gain enough insight into the subject to enable them to complete the course with a rounded knowledge of the approaches, processes and issues that have been chosen to illustrate it at GCSE level. The specification includes the requirement that candidates should carry out an internally assessed task involving a more detailed investigation to illustrate an aspect of the psychology that they study during the course.

The specification is built upon the understanding that psychological knowledge could be treated as being made up of a number of different approaches. What actually constitutes these approaches can stimulate endless debate; for the purposes of this specification, they include six approaches, each illustrated by two topic areas.

The approaches are:

- Social Psychology;
- Behavioural Psychology;
- Developmental Psychology;
- Individual Differentiation;
- Cognitive Psychology;
- Bio-psychology.

The material within the topic areas associated with the individual approaches should enable candidates to understand how particular methodologies, cultural constraints and ethical considerations can bring influence to bear upon the development of knowledge within each approach. The topic areas also provide an opportunity for the consideration of the impact of psychology on everyday life by looking at the applications of psychology. Therefore the specification has a number of underlying processes and issues which should be considered as an integral part of the material outlined in each topic area. This allows for the development of psychological skills as well as the learning of psychological knowledge.

OCR has taken great care in the preparation of this specification and assessment materials to avoid bias of any kind.